

Psychological Principles Handbook

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Attention: ONLY ACADEMIC PURPOSES. Use these materials for awareness and defensive training in authorized environments.

Cialdini Principles

Discuss reciprocity, commitment, social proof, authority, liking, and scarcity and how attackers exploit these psychological levers.

Application to Attacks

- Reciprocity: 'We did you a favor' baiting messages.
- Authority: impersonating executives to request wire transfers.
- Scarcity: fake urgent offers to bypass rational checks.

Training Recommendations

Teach employees to pause, verify, and use secondary channels for confirmation. Role-play exercises increase retention.

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